APRIL 12, 1945

The President's blood pressure was 300/190.

His doctor called the rise normal for his age.

> Rising blood pressure was seen as part of aging. No treatment was considered.

Franklin D. Roosevelt's readings.

1933	140/100
1941	188/105
1944	186/108
1945	300/190

The old rule of thumb:

100 + age

was treated as an acceptable systolic

April 12, 1945.

> Roosevelt dies of a cerebral hemorrhage at 63.

1948: Truman signs the National Heart Act.

> It funds a long-term study of heart disease.

One town signs up.

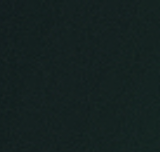
5,209

residents aged 28–62, first exams from October 1948

1961: a new idea goes mainstream.



Blood pressure



Smoking



Cholesterol

> Framingham researchers publish on risk factors for heart disease.

Your move this month:

1. Get your blood pressure checked
2. Write the numbers down
3. Ask a professional what yours mean